

Health & Wellbeing

66 words · Health & Wellbeing

NOUNS

symptom

a sign of illness experienced by the patient

Fever and fatigue are common symptoms of the virus.

appointment

a scheduled time to see a doctor or specialist

She made an appointment with her GP for the following Monday.

diet

the food and drink a person regularly consumes

She changed her diet and started eating more vegetables.

surgery

a medical procedure in which the body is cut open to treat a condition

She needed surgery to repair the torn ligament.

injury

physical damage to part of the body

He suffered a knee injury during training.

mental health

a person's emotional and psychological wellbeing

Mental health is just as important as physical health.

diagnosis

a doctor's identification of an illness based on symptoms and tests

The diagnosis came back as type 2 diabetes.

metabolism

the chemical processes in the body that convert food into energy

A slow metabolism can make it harder to maintain a healthy weight.

treatment

medical care given to a patient for an illness or injury

The treatment involves a course of antibiotics over seven days.

prescription

a written instruction from a doctor authorising medicine for a patient

The doctor gave her a prescription for painkillers.

recovery

the process of returning to health after illness or injury

His recovery from the operation took three months.

allergy

an adverse reaction by the immune system to a substance

She has a severe allergy to penicillin.

stress

mental or emotional strain caused by pressure or worry

Chronic stress can have serious effects on physical health.

check-up

a routine examination by a doctor to assess general health

She goes for an annual check-up every January.

inflammation

redness, swelling, and pain caused by infection or injury

Anti-inflammatory drugs help reduce the inflammation.

immune system

the body's defence mechanism against infection and disease

A poor diet weakens the immune system over time.

nutrition

the process of consuming the right foods for good health

Good nutrition in childhood is essential for healthy development.

burnout

physical and emotional exhaustion caused by prolonged stress

He was signed off work for a month with burnout.

placebo effect

a measurable improvement caused by belief in treatment rather than the treatment itself

The trial had to account for the placebo effect in its control group.

longevity

the length of time that someone or something lives, especially when this is unusually long

The talk was all about longevity: what the world's oldest people actually eat and do each day.

anxiety

a persistent feeling of worry, nervousness, or unease

She sought therapy for her anxiety after it began affecting her work.

prognosis

a medical prediction of how a disease is likely to develop

The prognosis was positive: a full recovery was expected within three months.

biohacking

the practice of making small, deliberate changes to diet, sleep, or exercise to improve how your body performs

He's deep into biohacking: fasting windows, cold plunges, a ring that tracks every heartbeat.

ADJECTIVES

fit

in good physical condition; healthy and active

He's incredibly fit for his age. He runs every day.

chronic

(of an illness or condition) persisting for a long time

He has a chronic back problem that flares up periodically.

sedentary

characterised by much sitting and little physical activity

A sedentary lifestyle is a major risk factor for heart disease.

run-down

tired and in poor health due to overwork or neglect of self-care

He'd been so run-down that even a minor cold knocked him out.

debilitating

making someone very weak or unable to function normally

The debilitating fatigue made it impossible for her to work.

healthy

in good physical or mental condition; promoting good health

Eating a balanced diet is the foundation of a healthy lifestyle.

overweight

above the recommended body weight for one's height

The doctor said he was overweight and advised more exercise.

contagious

(of a disease) spreadable from person to person by contact

The virus is highly contagious in enclosed spaces.

holistic

treating the whole person (physical, mental, and social) rather than just symptoms

She preferred a more holistic approach to her healthcare.

resilient

able to recover quickly from difficulty, illness, or stress

Children are remarkably resilient, but trauma still leaves lasting marks.

preventative

designed to stop something harmful from occurring

Preventative healthcare is far more cost-effective than treatment.

bedridden

confined to bed for an extended period due to illness or injury

She was bedridden for two weeks after catching pneumonia.

terminal

(of a disease) leading eventually to death; without prospect of recovery

He was given a terminal diagnosis and told to get his affairs in order.

PHRASAL VERBS

get over

to recover fully from an illness

It took her two weeks to get over the chest infection.

pass out

to lose consciousness

She passed out from dehydration during the half-marathon.

fight off

to successfully resist and recover from an illness

He managed to fight off the infection without antibiotics.

burn off

to use up calories or energy through physical activity

He goes for a run to burn off steam after work.

bounce back

to recover quickly and fully from illness or setback

She bounced back from the surgery much faster than expected.

wean off

to gradually reduce dependence on a substance or habit

The doctor helped her wean off the medication over three months.

push through

to complete something demanding despite pain or exhaustion

She pushed through the last miles on sheer willpower alone.

come down with

to begin to develop an illness

She came down with flu the day before her holiday.

cut down on

to reduce the amount of something harmful you consume

She was told to cut down on salt and processed foods.

work out

to do physical exercise, especially at a gym

She works out three times a week to manage her stress levels.

keep up

to maintain a habit, standard, or routine consistently

It's hard to keep up a healthy routine when you're travelling.

swear by

to have complete confidence in the effectiveness of something

My neighbour swears by cold showers every morning, though the evidence is pretty thin.

soldier on

to continue despite illness, pain, or difficulty

He soldiered on through the cold rather than take a day off.

COLLOCATIONS

catch a cold

to become infected with a common cold virus
He caught a cold after standing in the rain.

balanced diet

a diet containing the correct proportions of all essential nutrients
The key to good health is a balanced diet and regular exercise.

side effect

an unwanted effect caused by a medicine or medical treatment
Nausea is listed as a possible side effect, so it's best to take it with food.

blue zone

a region where an unusually high number of people live active lives past 100
The programme looked at diet and daily habits in blue zones like Okinawa and Sardinia.

IDIOMS

feel under the weather

to feel slightly unwell
I'm feeling a bit under the weather. I might skip the gym today.

on the mend

recovering and getting better after an illness
She's on the mend, back to work next week, hopefully.

take its toll

to cause gradual damage to someone's health or wellbeing
The years of overwork were beginning to take their toll.

go cold turkey

to stop a habit or addiction suddenly and completely
She gave up cigarettes by going cold turkey, not a single one since January.

in the pink

in excellent health or condition
She's in the pink. You'd never know she had surgery three months ago.

be back on your feet

to have recovered from illness and returned to normal activity
She was back on her feet within a week of the operation.

in good shape

in good physical condition; healthy and fit
For someone in their sixties, she's in remarkable shape.

a clean bill of health

a confirmation that someone is in good health after a medical examination
The consultant gave him a clean bill of health after the scan.

at death's door

extremely ill and close to dying
She described how she had been at death's door and miraculously recovered.

fall off the wagon

to return to a bad habit, especially drinking alcohol, after having managed to stop
He'd stayed off cigarettes for a year before falling off the wagon at a stressful work do.

SET PHRASES

everything in moderation

used to say that it's fine to enjoy something as long as you don't overdo it
She still has cake at parties. It's everything in moderation with her, not strict rules.

MODERN SLANG

knackered

extremely tired or exhausted (British informal)

I'm absolutely knackered after that gym session.

dodgy tummy

an upset stomach (British informal)

I've had a dodgy tummy since that kebab last night.